

TÜRKİYE'S DEMOGRAPHIC TRANSFORMATION:

WHAT HAS CHANGED IN 12 YEARS?

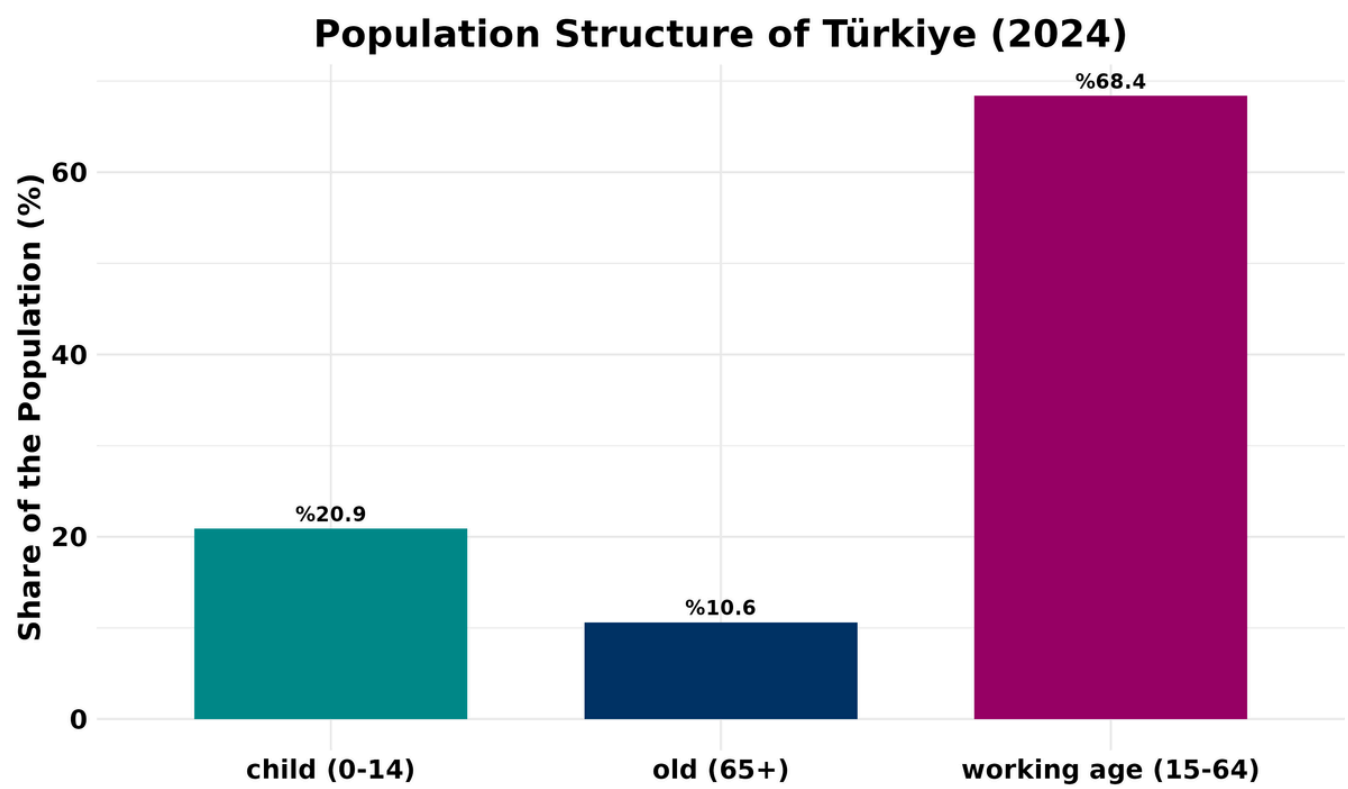
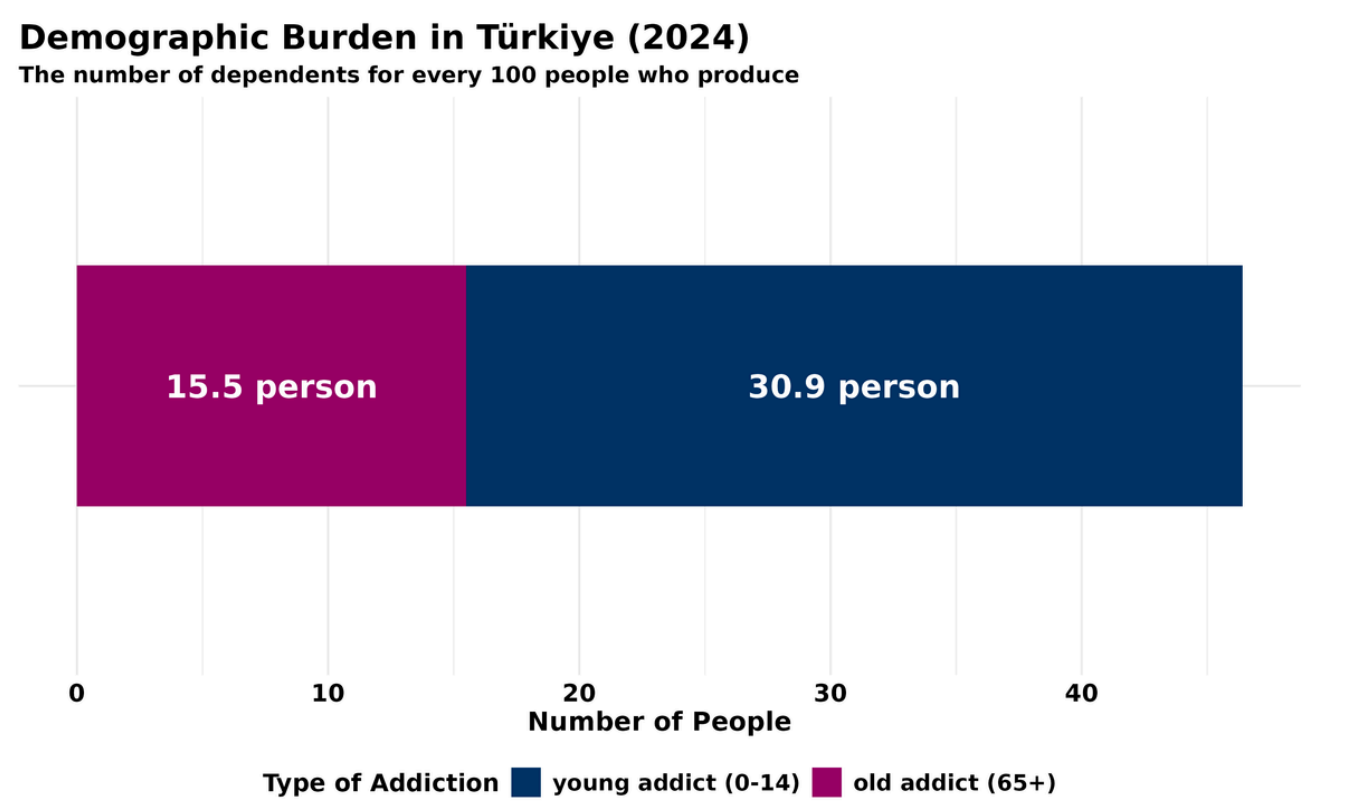
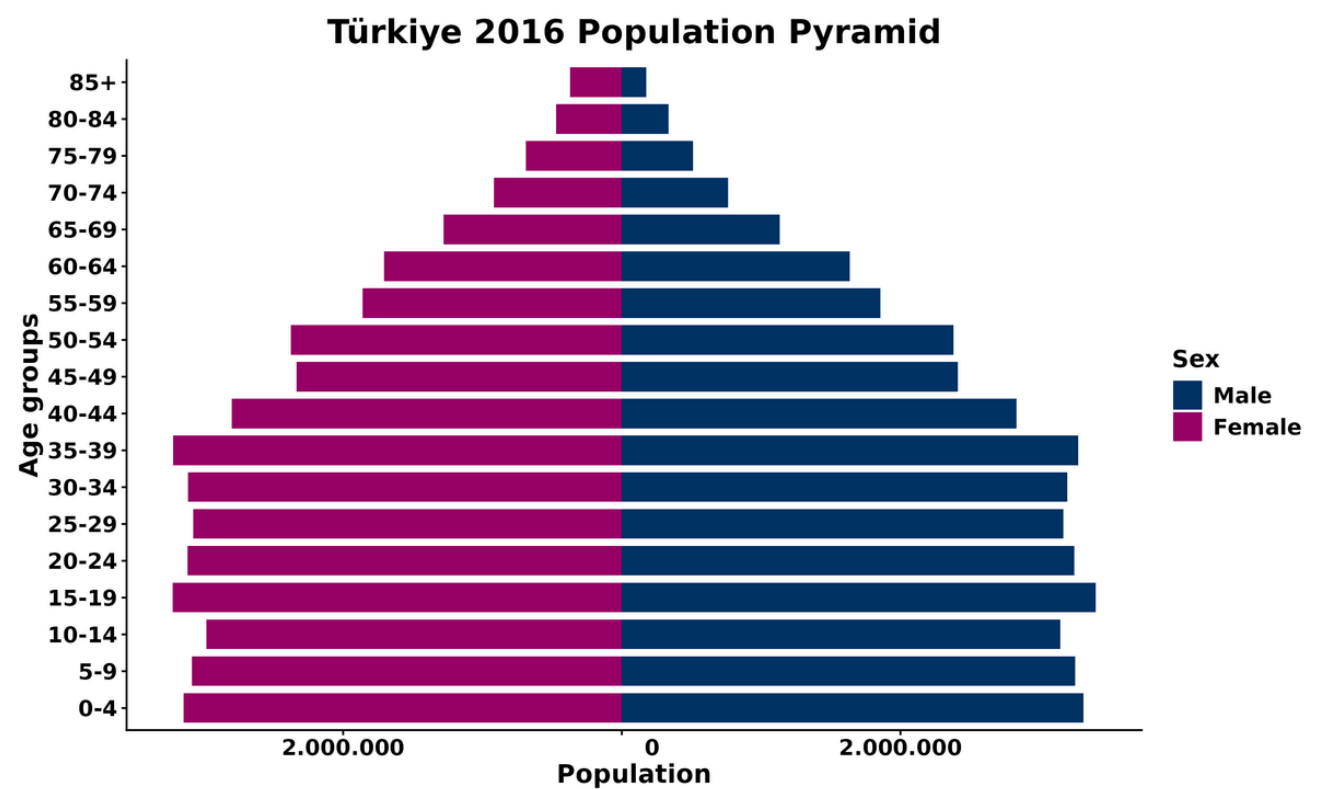
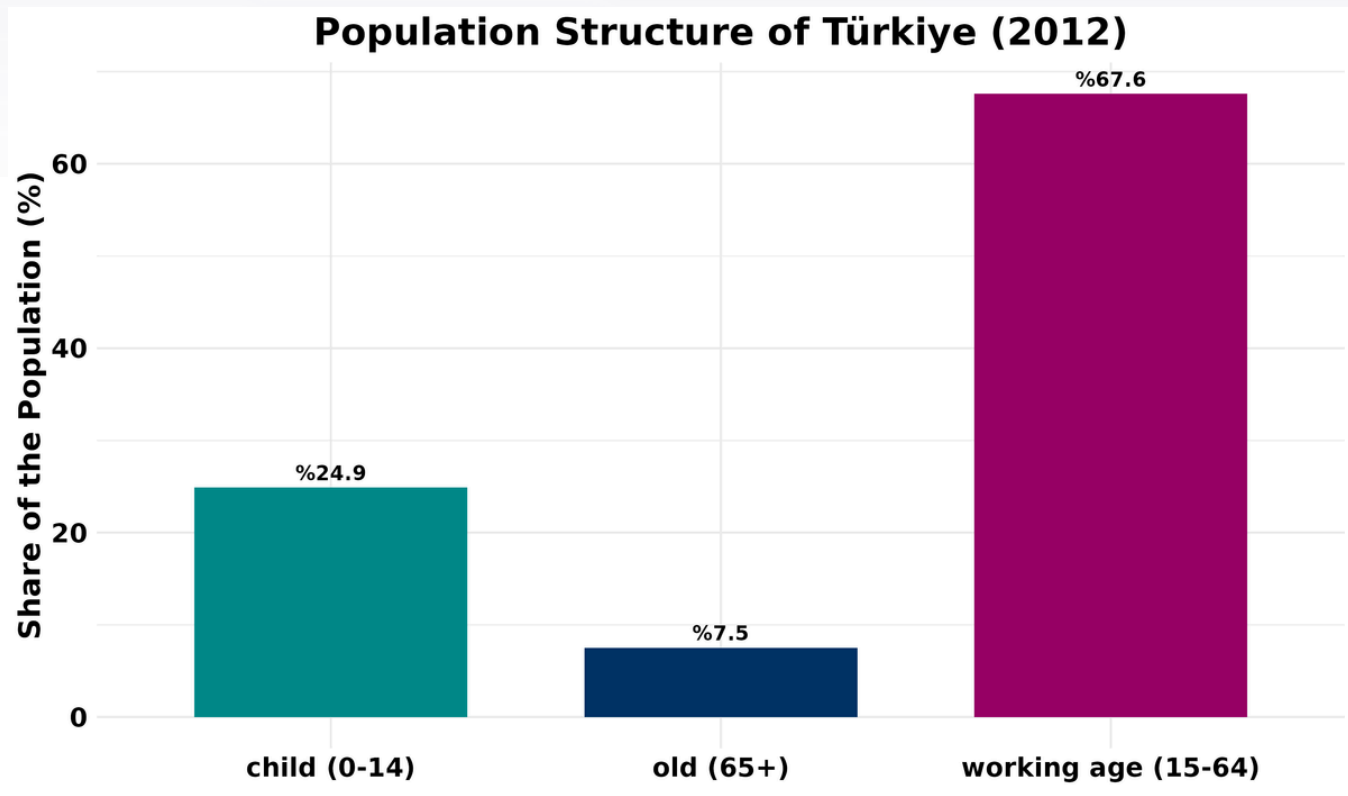
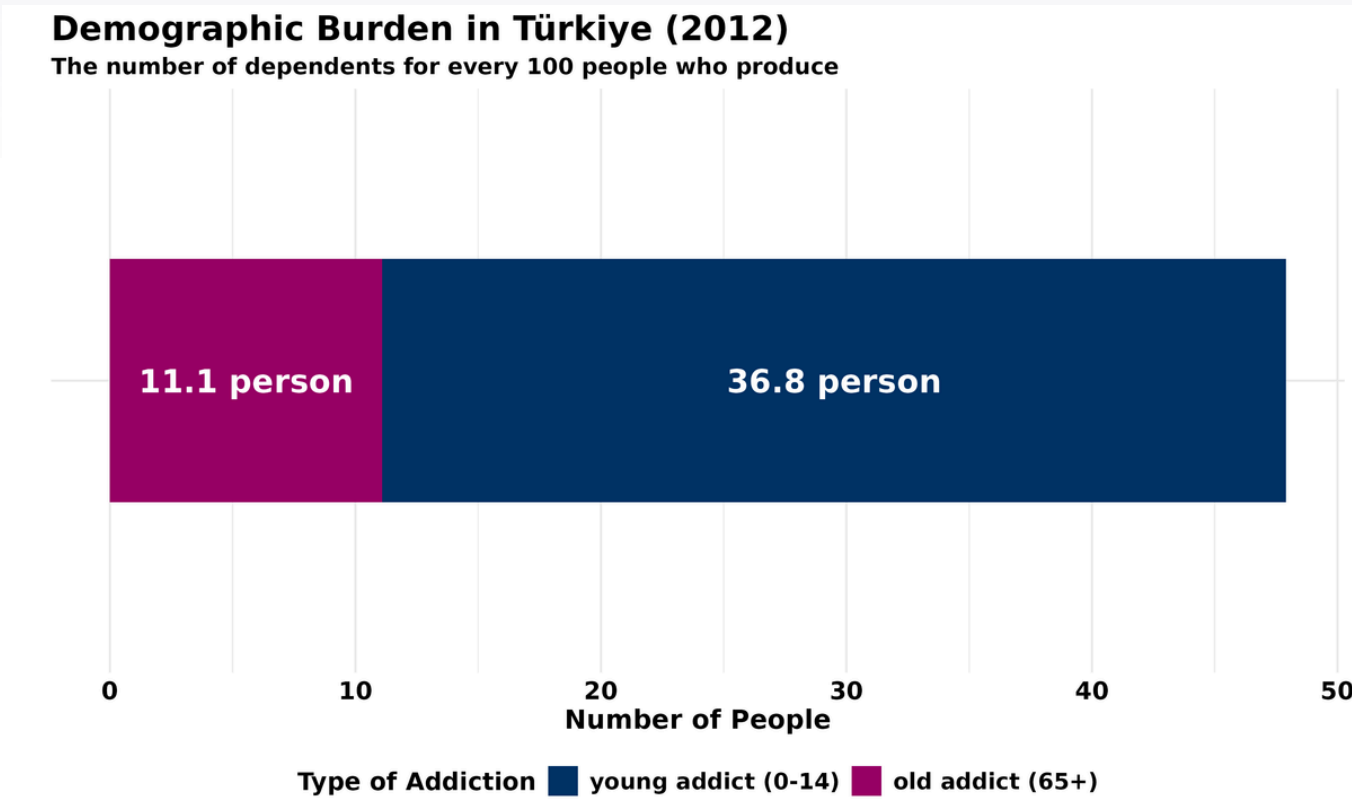
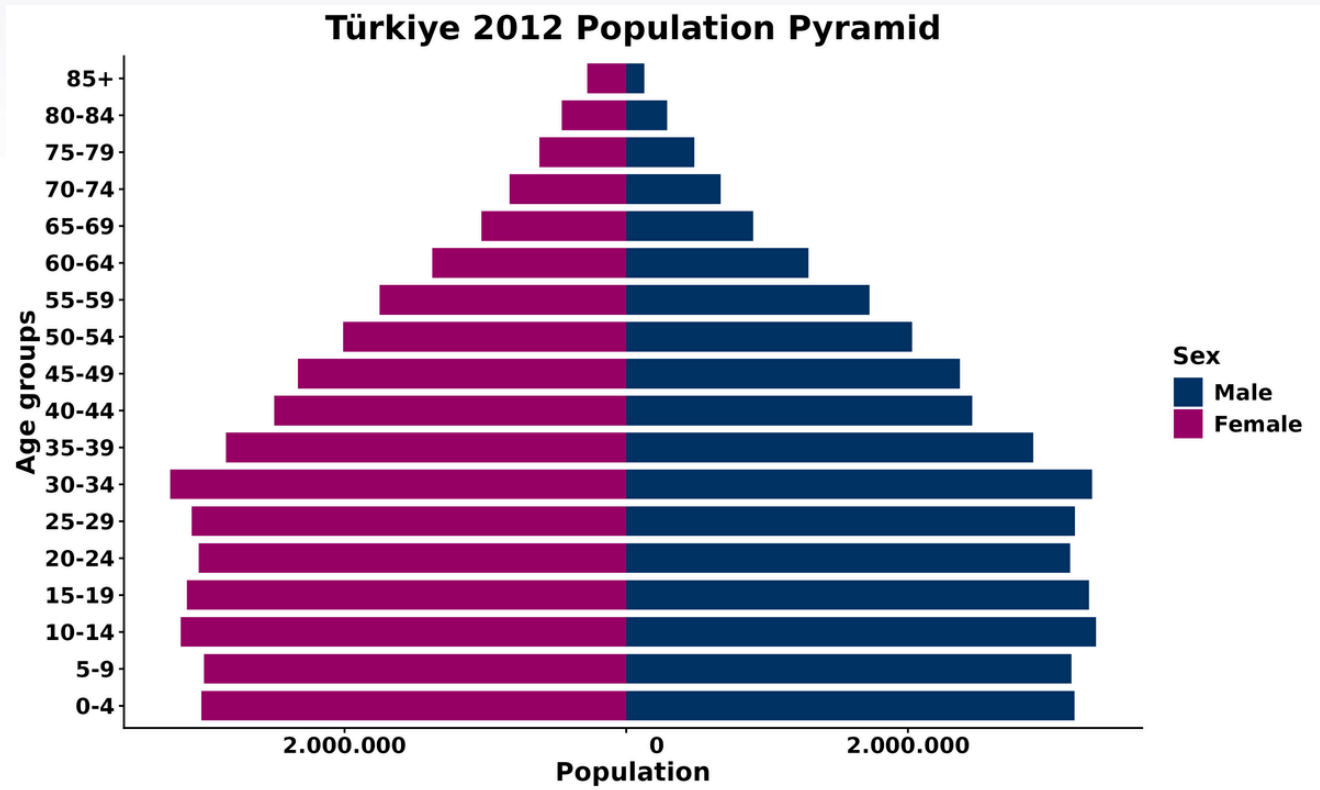


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Is This the End of Young Türkiye? The Transformation of the Pyramid: We are shifting from a "young and dynamic" triangular form to a "barrel" model dominated by middle age.

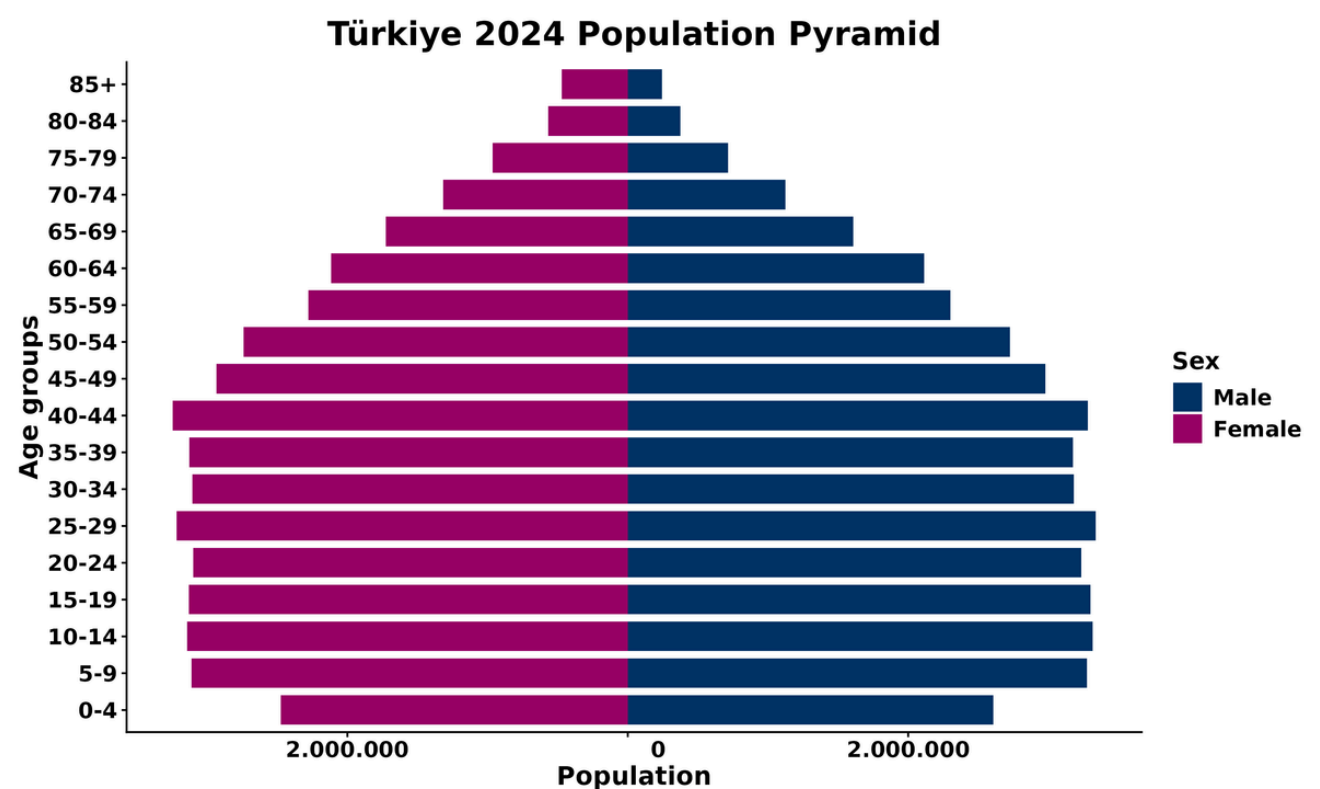
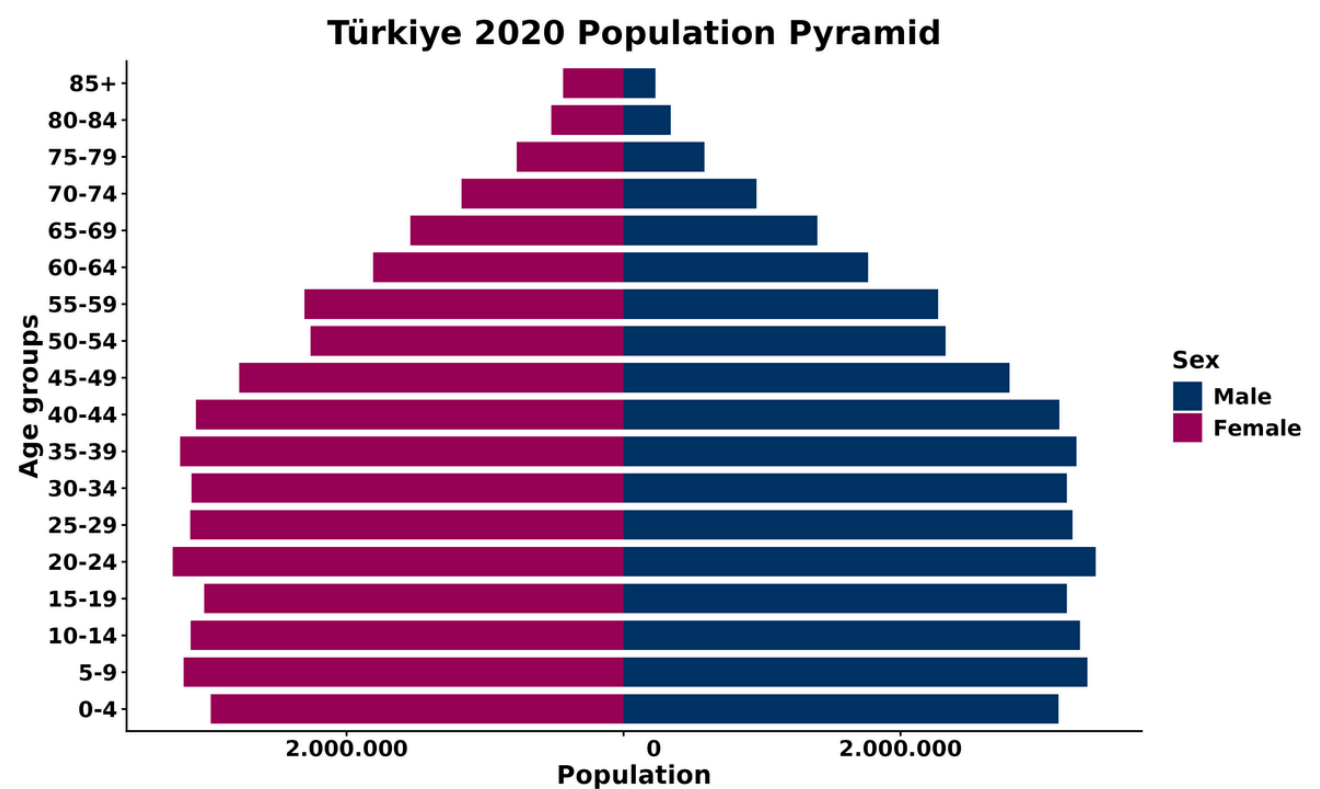
Is the Window of Opportunity Closing? While child dependency ratios are falling, the massive 40% increase in elderly dependency ratios signals a new era for health and pension systems.

Spatial Mobility: The population is not only aging, but also displacing. While Central and Eastern Anatolia are depopulating, the western provinces, the driving force of industry and tourism, are bearing the brunt of a massive wave of migration.

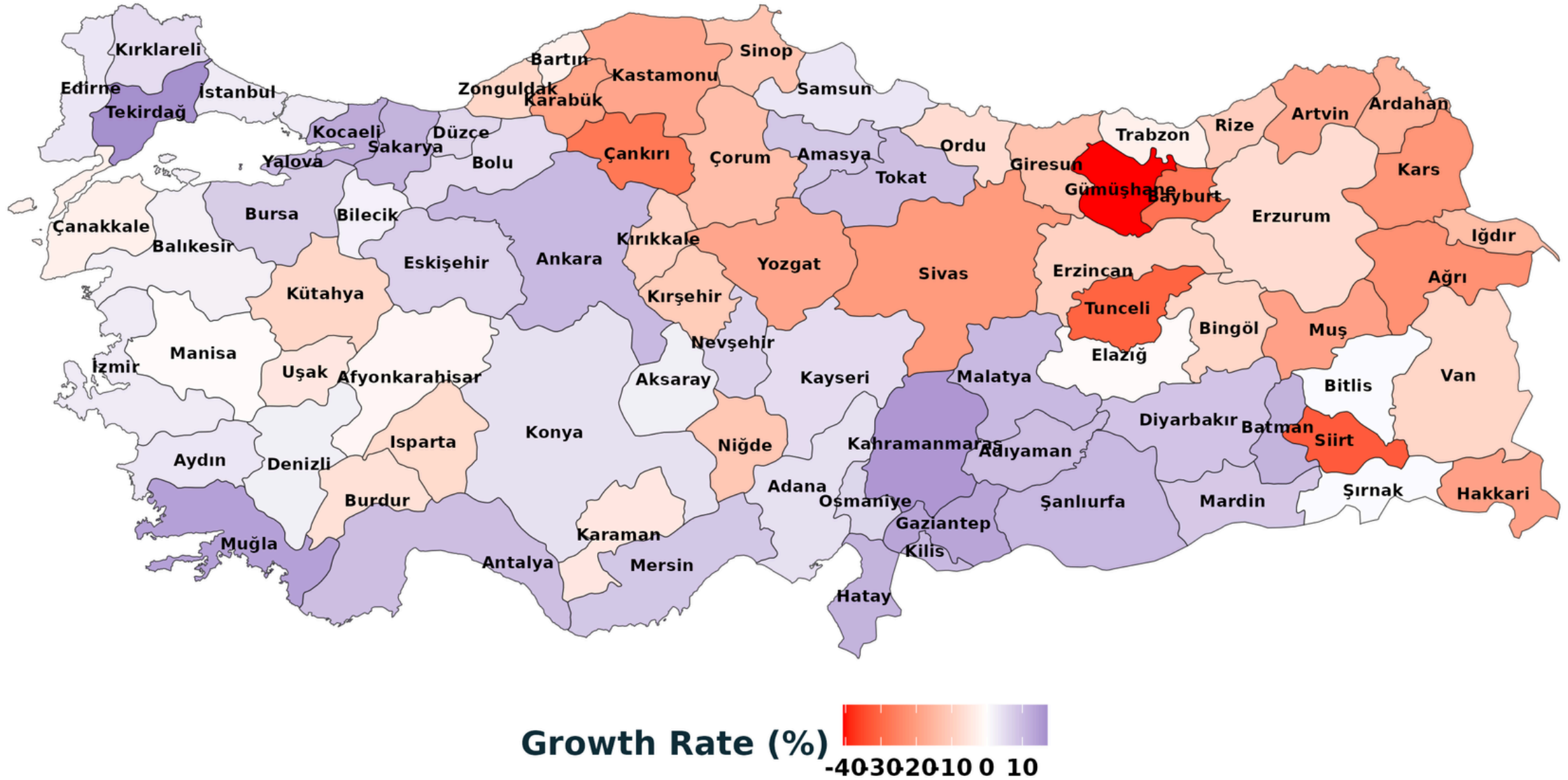


Between 2012 and 2024, Türkiye underwent a rapid demographic transformation, moving from a young and dynamic population to an aging society. In 2012, the demographic window was wide open, with a child dependency ratio of 36.8 and a low elderly dependency ratio of 11.1, meaning the burden of elder care on the workforce was minimal. However, by 2024, the child dependency ratio dropped to 30.9 due to declining birth rates, while the elderly dependency ratio surged by nearly 40% to 15.5. This shift indicates that Türkiye is losing its young population advantage as the burden moves from childcare to elderly support. Consequently, economic planning must now evolve from focusing on youth investments toward addressing the rising pressures on healthcare expenditures and pension systems.

Between 2012 and 2024, Türkiye underwent a significant demographic shift from a young, dynamic population to a rapidly aging society. In 2012, the country benefited from an open demographic window of opportunity, with children making up 24.9% of the population and the elderly only 7.5%. However, by 2024, declining birth rates reduced the child share to 20.9%, while the elderly population surged by 41% to reach 10.6%. Although the working-age population remains high at 68.4%, the narrowing of the population pyramid's base indicates that this opportunity window is slowly closing. This transformation shifts the dependency burden toward the elderly, signaling future pressure on pension systems and healthcare expenditures as the nation moves away from its traditional young-population advantage.



Türkiye's 2024 Population Growth Rate



The population growth rate is negative in the inland areas of the Black Sea region (such as Gümüşhane, Bayburt, and Çankırı) and some provinces of Eastern Anatolia (around Tunceli and Siirt). These provinces are experiencing significant outward migration. Population growth rates are positive in Western Anatolia (Tekirdağ, the area around Istanbul, Muğla), Southern Anatolia (the area around Antalya), and parts of Southeastern Anatolia. This indicates that industrialized provinces and tourism regions continue to receive migration. While western and coastal regions of Türkiye continue to attract population, it is noteworthy that many provinces in the interior and eastern regions are experiencing population decline.

